It differed from the previous year's celebration in two ways. First, I didn't drink. This year J was driving, and that meant no funny stuff. Second, there was kissing going on. (There may have been more than that, for all I know, but I was aware only of kissing.)

I took part in the kissing, too, for the one thing I particularly remember about that evening was kissing Evelyn Harrison, the pretty wife of Harry Harrison (who was then just beginning what was to become a career as a science-fiction writer of the first rank). Rather without my intending it, it became a passionate kiss—something I didn't indulge in outside the marital bond. It lasted quite a while by the time we pulled apart.

It was a little frightening to find myself reacting so, but rather pleasing to find I was inducing a woman to react so.

It was a pleasant thought for the next morning. That, and the fact that my writing earnings were very nearly equal to my instructor's salary so that I hadn't really lied to the dentist at Breadloaf four months before. That, and the subsidiary thought that my total income for 1950

was very nearly $10,000, a figure I had always thought of as the dream income representing the absolute limit of which I was capable.

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But I couldn't linger over the past, for we were, as always, moving into the future at the same relentless, unvarying pace as always.

Though I had laughed heartily at Evelyn Gold's suggestion that Gertrude was pregnant, I didn't forget it. I put it to Gertrude on January 2, 1951, while we were driving to Boston. (That was one way of celebrating my thirty-first birthday.)

She admitted she thought she might be, but had been reluctant to speak of it for fear of seeming foolish. Figuring backward, she thought she might have become pregnant on December 1 or slightly before— shortly after the kidney-stone incident.

The next day we consulted Adler, and he told us how one went about arranging for a pregnancy test. On the fourth I rushed a urine sample downtown and on the fifth the results came in. Gertrude was indeed pregnant! When I had received news of Catherine's second pregnancy and had sighed over our own inability to do the same, Gertrude was about to be under way.